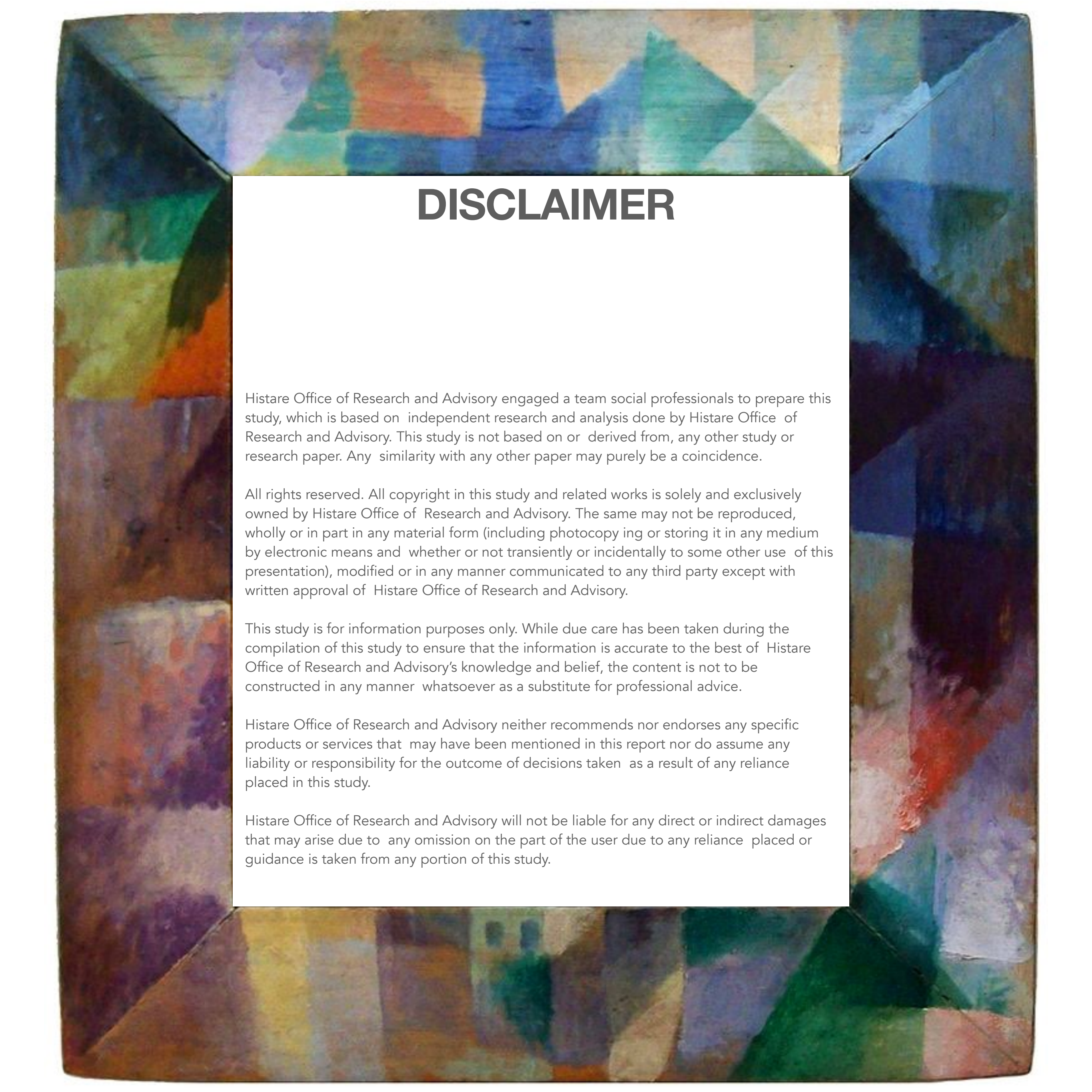




HISTARE[®]

CUBISM

THE TURNOVER POINT OF MODERN ART



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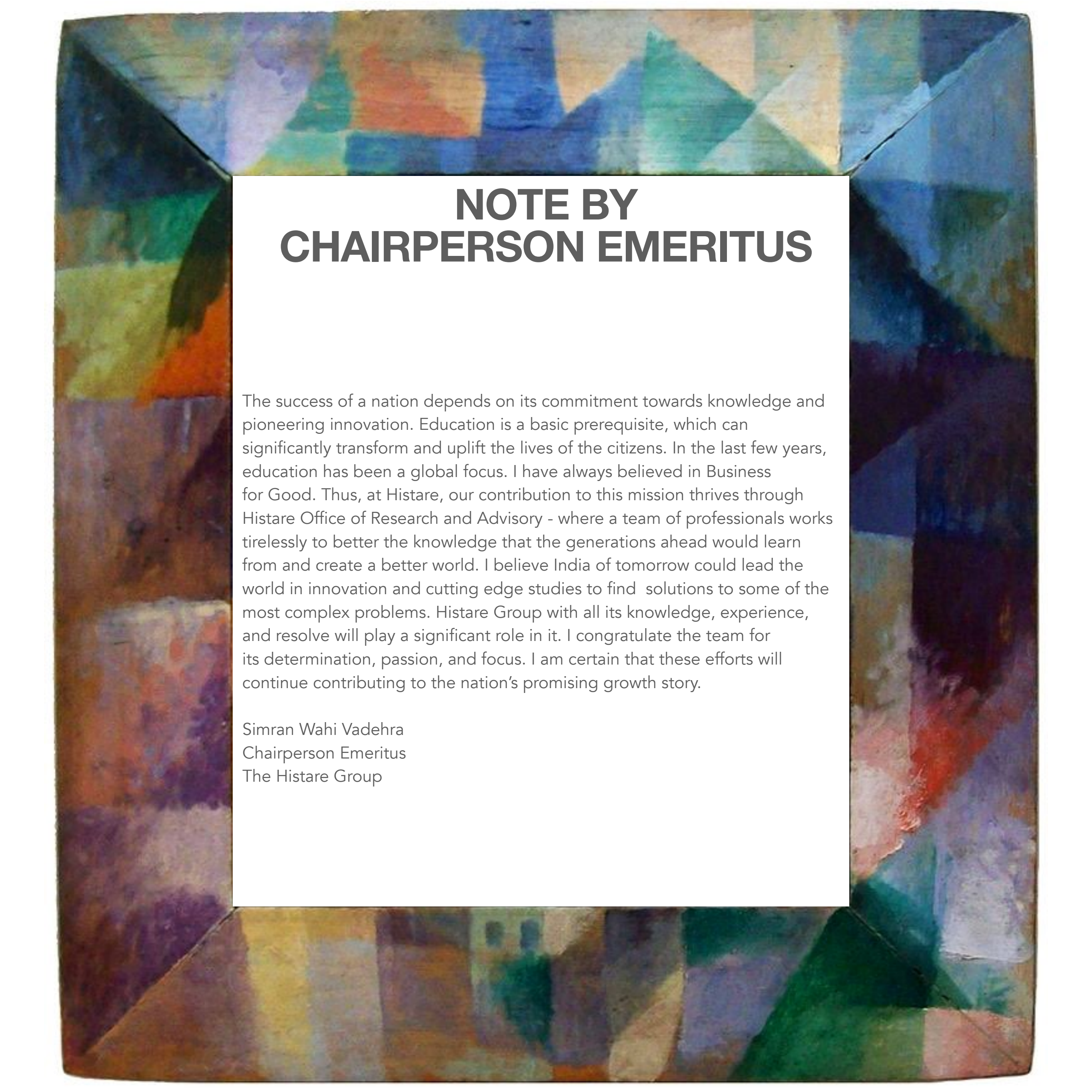
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NOTE BY CHAIRPERSON EMERITUS

The success of a nation depends on its commitment towards knowledge and pioneering innovation. Education is a basic prerequisite, which can significantly transform and uplift the lives of the citizens. In the last few years, education has been a global focus. I have always believed in Business for Good. Thus, at Histare, our contribution to this mission thrives through Histare Office of Research and Advisory - where a team of professionals works tirelessly to better the knowledge that the generations ahead would learn from and create a better world. I believe India of tomorrow could lead the world in innovation and cutting edge studies to find solutions to some of the most complex problems. Histare Group with all its knowledge, experience, and resolve will play a significant role in it. I congratulate the team for its determination, passion, and focus. I am certain that these efforts will continue contributing to the nation's promising growth story.

Simran Wahi Vadehra
Chairperson Emeritus
The Histare Group



HISTARE OFFICE OF RESEARCH AND ADVISORY

This study is prepared by Histare Office of Research and Advisory's team of social professionals under the guidance of Educationalists and Analysts associated with us.

The Histare Office of Research and Advisory is an interdisciplinary professional organization of young researchers and art specialists focused on stimulating and supporting the study that strives to promote advances in the study of creativity and innovation for finding ways for the development of the world.

Histare Office of Research and Advisory is an institution for the study of creative ideology and advances research with a view to promote Development in the field of creativity. We represent a broad range of disciplines. The initiative encourages Cooperation among professionals and supports the application of research findings to broaden better knowledge absorption.

Dr Rikimi Madhukaillya

Director - HORA

The Histare Group

Associate Professor - Pearl Academy

Former Art Writer, Critic, and Curator - Osianama Group

Former Curator - National Gallery of Modern Art

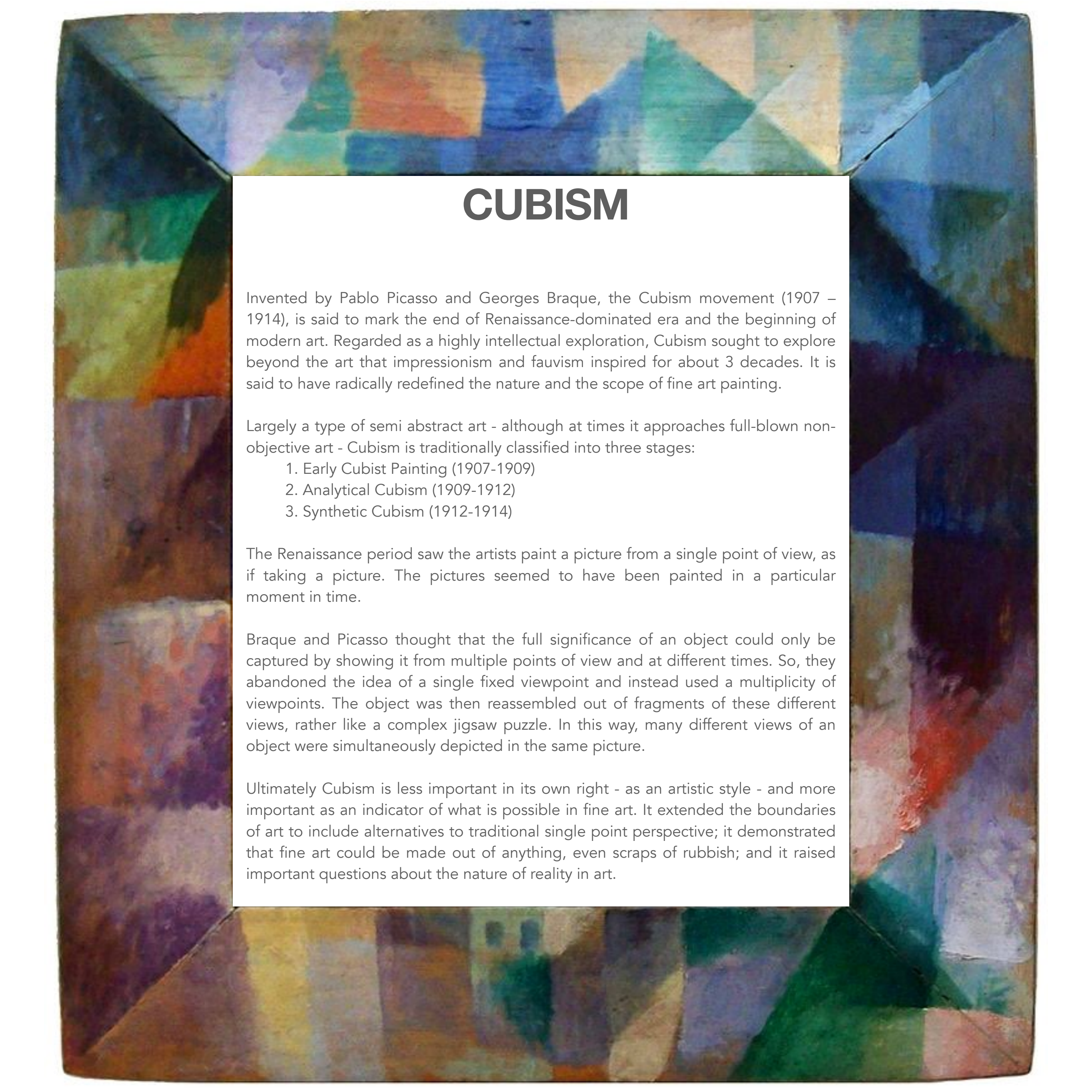
The background of the entire page is an abstract painting composed of various geometric shapes like triangles and rectangles in a rich palette of blues, greens, yellows, oranges, and purples. A large, clean white rectangle is centered on the page, serving as a container for the text.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We are grateful to the team that researched extensively on this concept of the Indian Art Ecosystem. This study especially focuses on the work that we intend to do.

We would like to thank Brig. Chukerbuti for his active participation. The success of this study has been through his collaborative efforts. Brig. Chukerbuti has been instrumental in building the right team for the study by providing his guidance.

In addition, we convey our gratitude to all those who have, in some way or another, contributed towards the successful completion of this study.



CUBISM

Invented by Pablo Picasso and Georges Braque, the Cubism movement (1907 – 1914), is said to mark the end of Renaissance-dominated era and the beginning of modern art. Regarded as a highly intellectual exploration, Cubism sought to explore beyond the art that impressionism and fauvism inspired for about 3 decades. It is said to have radically redefined the nature and the scope of fine art painting.

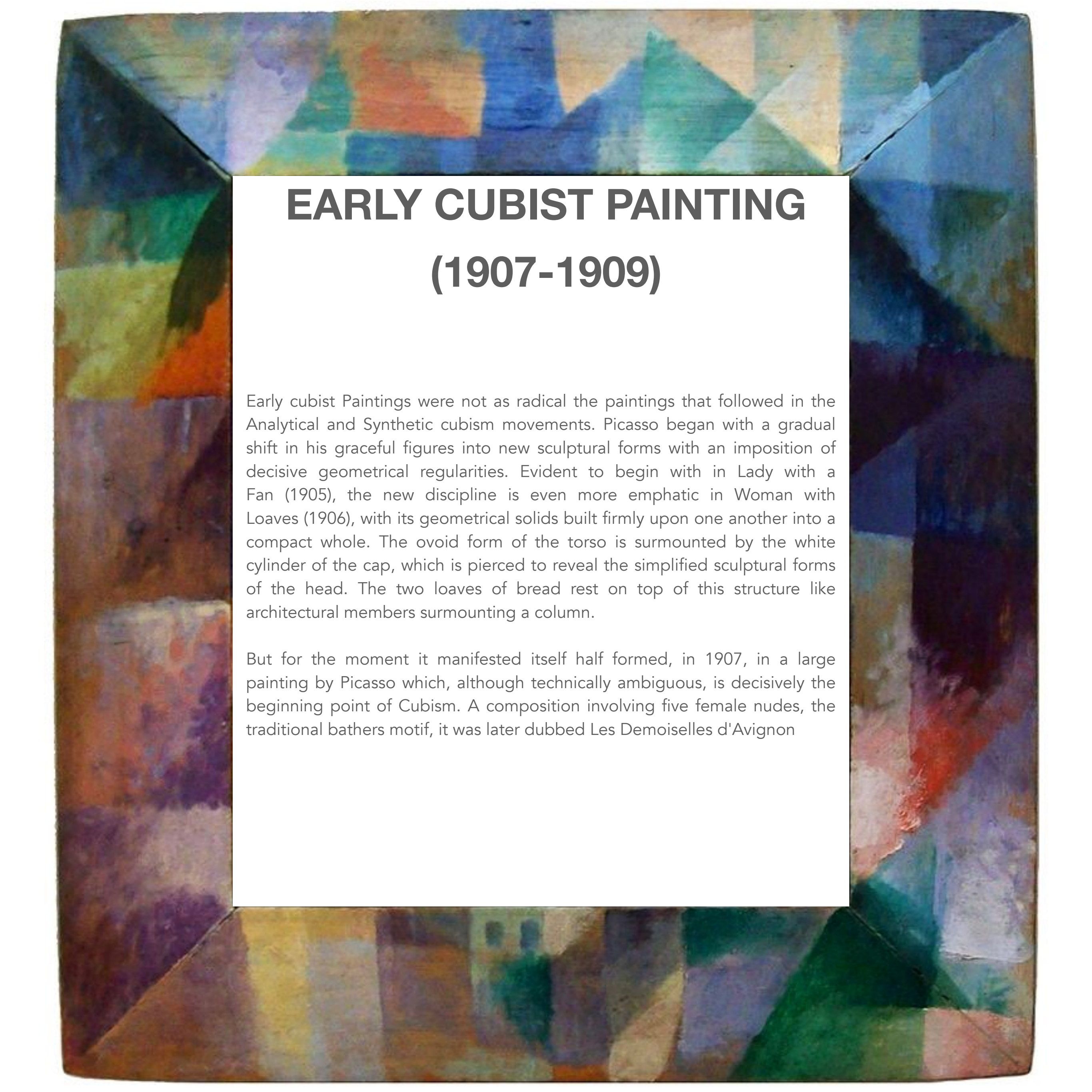
Largely a type of semi abstract art - although at times it approaches full-blown non-objective art - Cubism is traditionally classified into three stages:

1. Early Cubist Painting (1907-1909)
2. Analytical Cubism (1909-1912)
3. Synthetic Cubism (1912-1914)

The Renaissance period saw the artists paint a picture from a single point of view, as if taking a picture. The pictures seemed to have been painted in a particular moment in time.

Braque and Picasso thought that the full significance of an object could only be captured by showing it from multiple points of view and at different times. So, they abandoned the idea of a single fixed viewpoint and instead used a multiplicity of viewpoints. The object was then reassembled out of fragments of these different views, rather like a complex jigsaw puzzle. In this way, many different views of an object were simultaneously depicted in the same picture.

Ultimately Cubism is less important in its own right - as an artistic style - and more important as an indicator of what is possible in fine art. It extended the boundaries of art to include alternatives to traditional single point perspective; it demonstrated that fine art could be made out of anything, even scraps of rubbish; and it raised important questions about the nature of reality in art.



EARLY CUBIST PAINTING

(1907-1909)

Early cubist Paintings were not as radical the paintings that followed in the Analytical and Synthetic cubism movements. Picasso began with a gradual shift in his graceful figures into new sculptural forms with an imposition of decisive geometrical regularities. Evident to begin with in *Lady with a Fan* (1905), the new discipline is even more emphatic in *Woman with Loaves* (1906), with its geometrical solids built firmly upon one another into a compact whole. The ovoid form of the torso is surmounted by the white cylinder of the cap, which is pierced to reveal the simplified sculptural forms of the head. The two loaves of bread rest on top of this structure like architectural members surmounting a column.

But for the moment it manifested itself half formed, in 1907, in a large painting by Picasso which, although technically ambiguous, is decisively the beginning point of Cubism. A composition involving five female nudes, the traditional bathers motif, it was later dubbed *Les Femmes d'Alger* (O.J. no. 111) and *Les Femmes d'Alger* (O.J. no. 112).

EARLY CUBIST PAINTING (1907-1909)

The Metamorphosis of Picasso's Masterpieces

Picasso,
Lady with a Fan
1905



Picasso,
Woman with Loaves
1906



Picasso,
Les Femmes d'Alger (O.J.)
1907





EARLY CUBIST PAINTING

(1907-1909)

At the start of 1907, Braque was known as a member of Fauvism, the high-fashion style of colourism, however in 1907, Braque was bowled over by *Les Femmes d'Alger*. So much so that he abandoned Fauvism and spent the next six months working on a new picture - *Large Nude* (1908) - which required him to transform his whole method of painting.

Unlike Picasso, however, Braque moved directly directly from his *Large Nude* to more overt Cubist imagery (in the manner of Cezanne), namely his landscapes at L'Estaque. So by late 1908, stylistically he was fractionally ahead of his Spanish partner.

In this early phase of prototype-Cubism, Picasso and Braque utilized several technical devices to undermine the illusion of space. Instead the perspective was rendered by means of colour: warm reddish browns were used for foreground, cool blues for background.

Another technique used by both Braque and Picasso in their early Cubist art, involved the use of different light sources. In Cubist canvases light appears to enter the composition from numerous different angles thus confusing the viewer as to whether shapes are convex or concave.

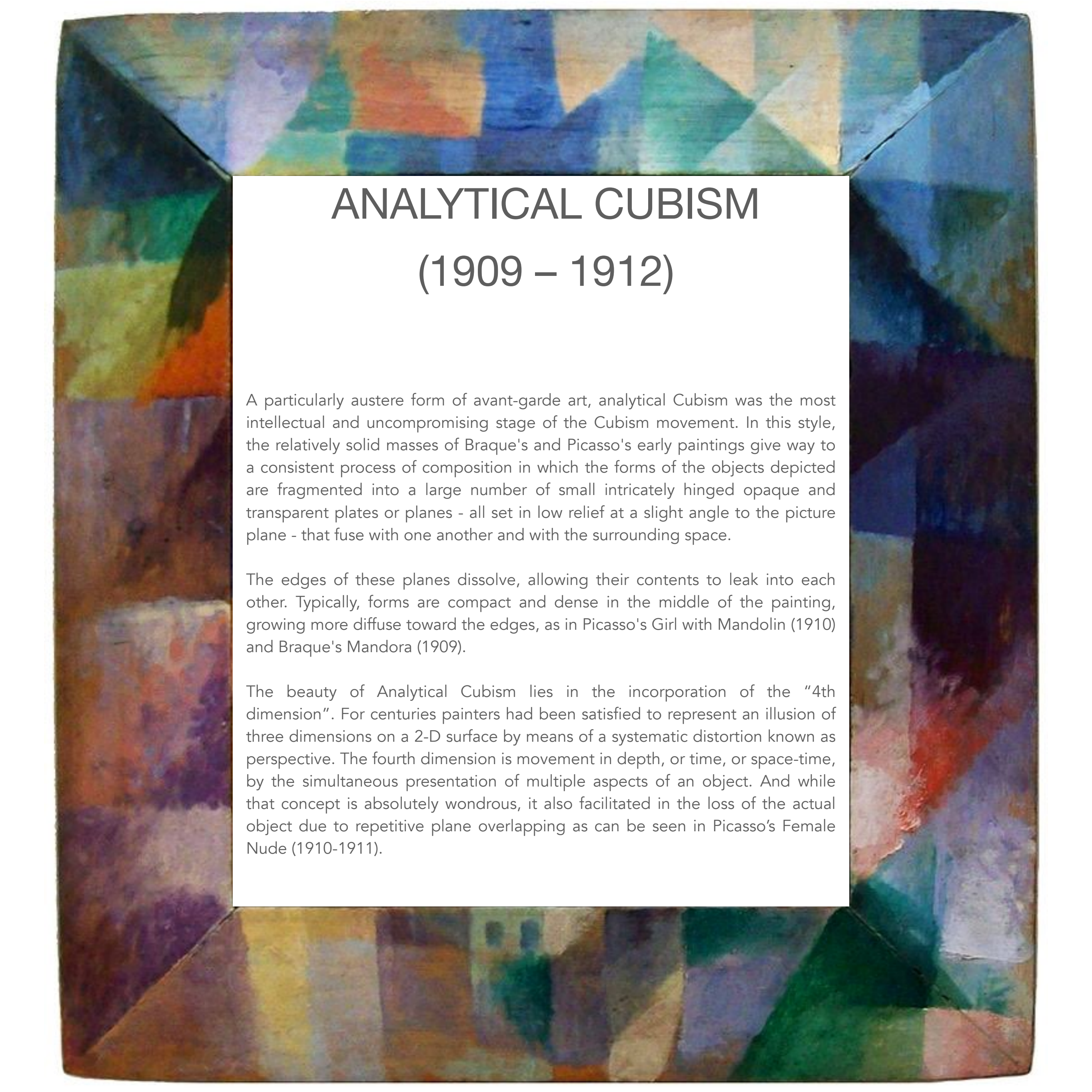
EARLY CUBIST PAINTING (1907-1909)



Braque,
Large Nude
1908



Braque,
Road near L'Estaque
1908

The background of the slide is a large, abstract painting in the Analytical Cubism style. It features a complex arrangement of overlapping, semi-transparent planes in various colors including deep blues, purples, greens, and earthy browns. The composition is non-representational, focusing on the interplay of color and geometric forms. The central text is overlaid on a white rectangular area.

ANALYTICAL CUBISM

(1909 – 1912)

A particularly austere form of avant-garde art, analytical Cubism was the most intellectual and uncompromising stage of the Cubism movement. In this style, the relatively solid masses of Braque's and Picasso's early paintings give way to a consistent process of composition in which the forms of the objects depicted are fragmented into a large number of small intricately hinged opaque and transparent plates or planes - all set in low relief at a slight angle to the picture plane - that fuse with one another and with the surrounding space.

The edges of these planes dissolve, allowing their contents to leak into each other. Typically, forms are compact and dense in the middle of the painting, growing more diffuse toward the edges, as in Picasso's *Girl with Mandolin* (1910) and Braque's *Mandora* (1909).

The beauty of Analytical Cubism lies in the incorporation of the "4th dimension". For centuries painters had been satisfied to represent an illusion of three dimensions on a 2-D surface by means of a systematic distortion known as perspective. The fourth dimension is movement in depth, or time, or space-time, by the simultaneous presentation of multiple aspects of an object. And while that concept is absolutely wondrous, it also facilitated in the loss of the actual object due to repetitive plane overlapping as can be seen in Picasso's *Female Nude* (1910-1911).

ANALYTICAL CUBISM

(1909 – 1912)



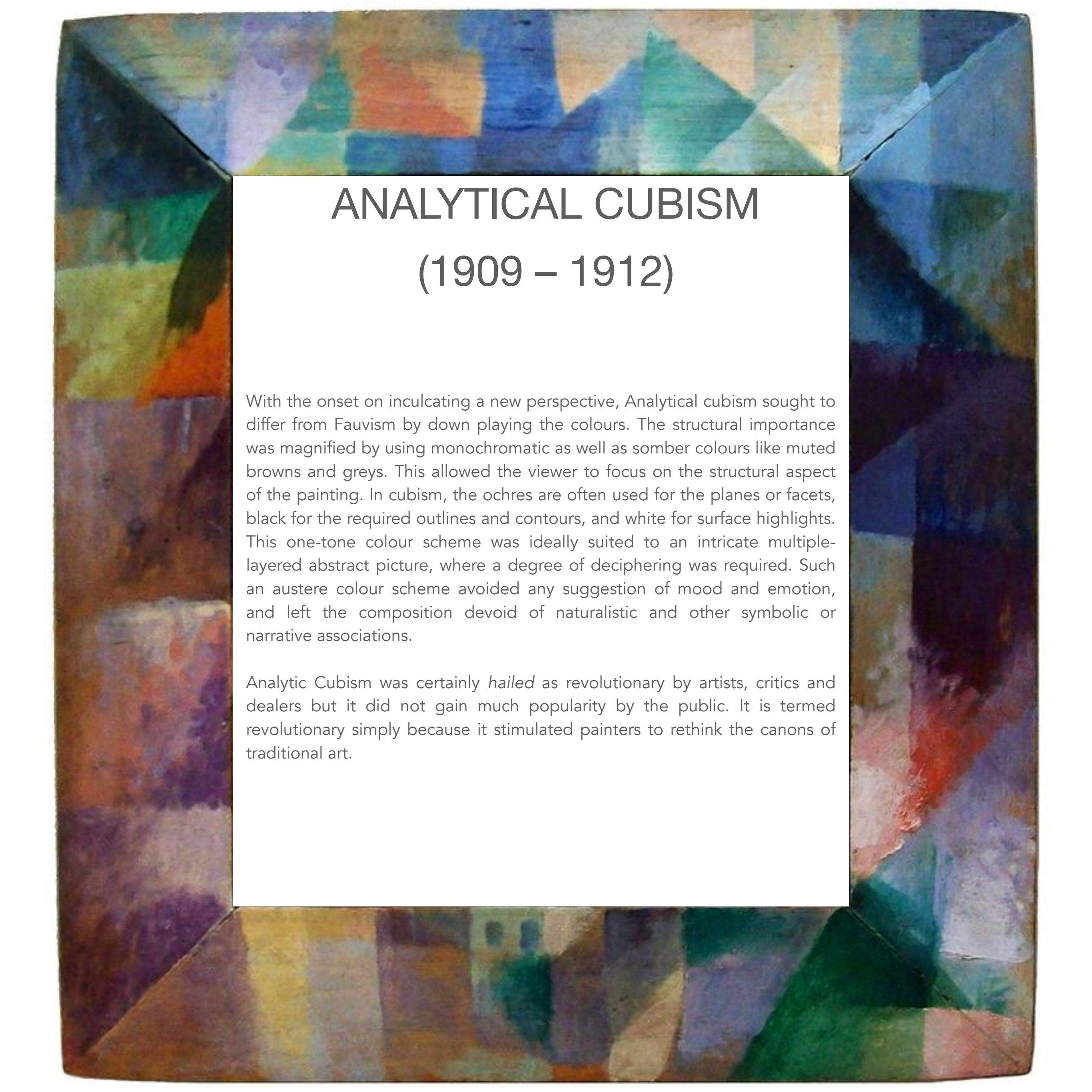
Picasso,
Girl with Mandolin
1910



Braque,
Mandora
1909



Picasso,
Female Nude
1910 - 1911

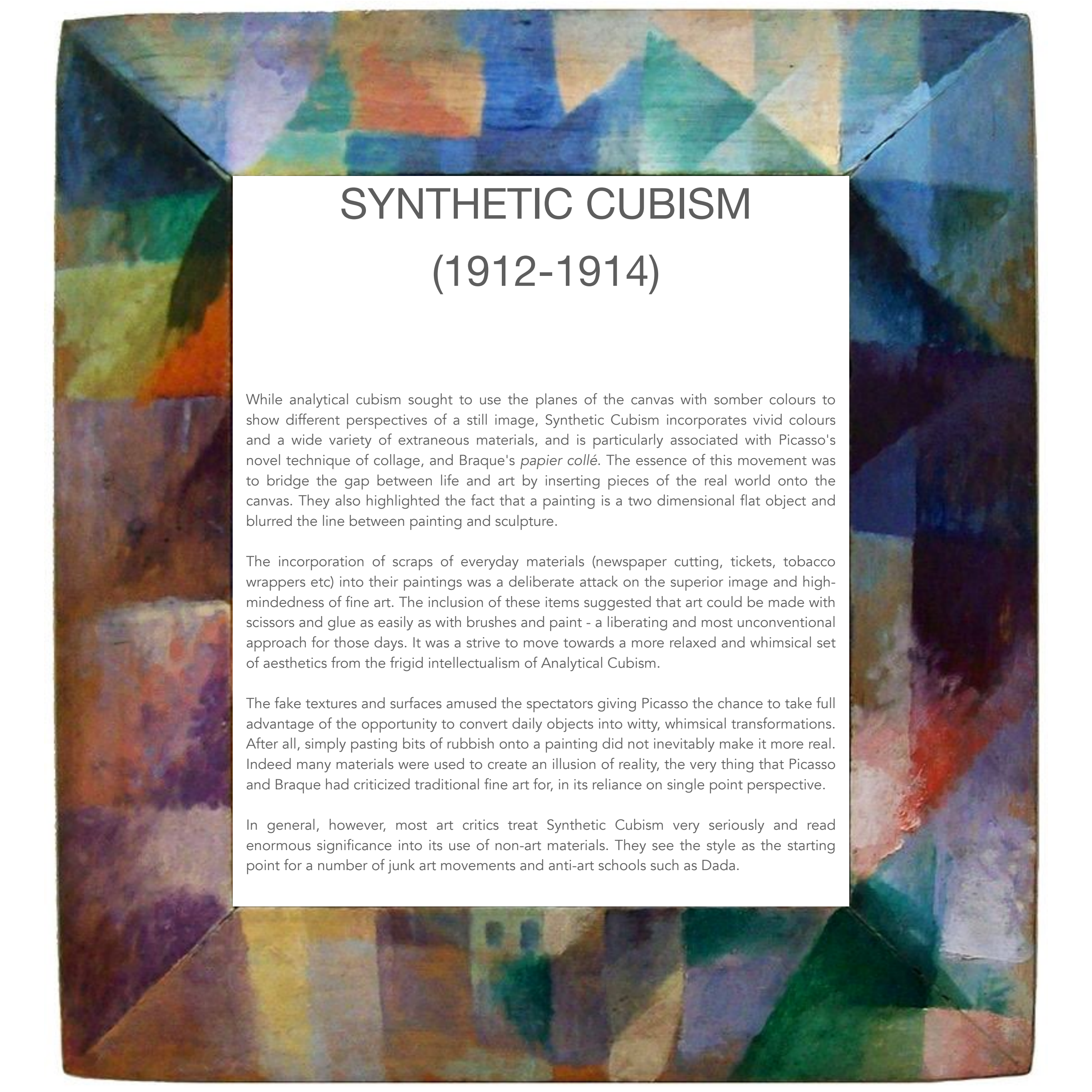
An abstract painting in the Analytical Cubism style, featuring a complex composition of geometric shapes and a muted color palette. The painting is divided into several distinct sections, each with its own color scheme. The top section is dominated by shades of blue and green, while the bottom section features a mix of brown, purple, and yellow. The central area is a mix of these colors, creating a sense of depth and complexity. The overall effect is one of a highly structured, multi-layered abstract work.

ANALYTICAL CUBISM

(1909 – 1912)

With the onset on inculcating a new perspective, Analytical cubism sought to differ from Fauvism by down playing the colours. The structural importance was magnified by using monochromatic as well as somber colours like muted browns and greys. This allowed the viewer to focus on the structural aspect of the painting. In cubism, the ochres are often used for the planes or facets, black for the required outlines and contours, and white for surface highlights. This one-tone colour scheme was ideally suited to an intricate multiple-layered abstract picture, where a degree of deciphering was required. Such an austere colour scheme avoided any suggestion of mood and emotion, and left the composition devoid of naturalistic and other symbolic or narrative associations.

Analytic Cubism was certainly *hailed* as revolutionary by artists, critics and dealers but it did not gain much popularity by the public. It is termed revolutionary simply because it stimulated painters to rethink the canons of traditional art.



SYNTHETIC CUBISM

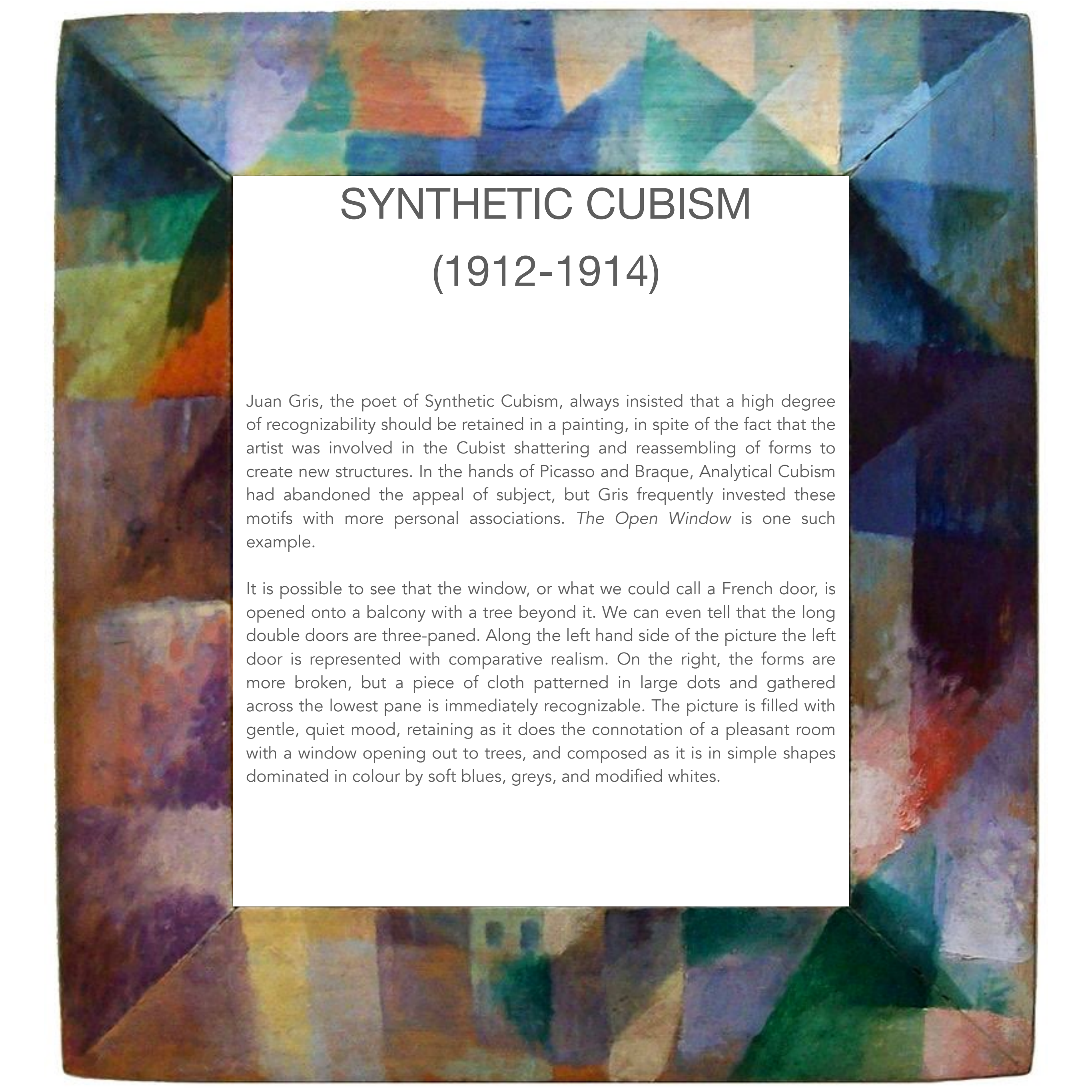
(1912-1914)

While analytical cubism sought to use the planes of the canvas with somber colours to show different perspectives of a still image, Synthetic Cubism incorporates vivid colours and a wide variety of extraneous materials, and is particularly associated with Picasso's novel technique of collage, and Braque's *papier collé*. The essence of this movement was to bridge the gap between life and art by inserting pieces of the real world onto the canvas. They also highlighted the fact that a painting is a two dimensional flat object and blurred the line between painting and sculpture.

The incorporation of scraps of everyday materials (newspaper cutting, tickets, tobacco wrappers etc) into their paintings was a deliberate attack on the superior image and high-mindedness of fine art. The inclusion of these items suggested that art could be made with scissors and glue as easily as with brushes and paint - a liberating and most unconventional approach for those days. It was a strive to move towards a more relaxed and whimsical set of aesthetics from the frigid intellectualism of Analytical Cubism.

The fake textures and surfaces amused the spectators giving Picasso the chance to take full advantage of the opportunity to convert daily objects into witty, whimsical transformations. After all, simply pasting bits of rubbish onto a painting did not inevitably make it more real. Indeed many materials were used to create an illusion of reality, the very thing that Picasso and Braque had criticized traditional fine art for, in its reliance on single point perspective.

In general, however, most art critics treat Synthetic Cubism very seriously and read enormous significance into its use of non-art materials. They see the style as the starting point for a number of junk art movements and anti-art schools such as Dada.



SYNTHETIC CUBISM

(1912-1914)

Juan Gris, the poet of Synthetic Cubism, always insisted that a high degree of recognizability should be retained in a painting, in spite of the fact that the artist was involved in the Cubist shattering and reassembling of forms to create new structures. In the hands of Picasso and Braque, Analytical Cubism had abandoned the appeal of subject, but Gris frequently invested these motifs with more personal associations. *The Open Window* is one such example.

It is possible to see that the window, or what we could call a French door, is opened onto a balcony with a tree beyond it. We can even tell that the long double doors are three-paned. Along the left hand side of the picture the left door is represented with comparative realism. On the right, the forms are more broken, but a piece of cloth patterned in large dots and gathered across the lowest pane is immediately recognizable. The picture is filled with gentle, quiet mood, retaining as it does the connotation of a pleasant room with a window opening out to trees, and composed as it is in simple shapes dominated in colour by soft blues, greys, and modified whites.

SYNTHETIC CUBISM

(1912-1914)



Juan Gris,
The Open Window
1917



Picasso,
Still Life with Chair-
Caning,
1911-12



SUMMARY

What can be rightly known as the absolute face changing art movement of its time, Cubism can easily be recognized as the basis of modern art by all viewers alike. Pablo Picasso and Georges Braque sought to be the renegades of the traditional art society, put in place a new definition of fine art. From using different view points of the still object to correctly define it in all planes to using scissors and glue for sticking everyday materials onto the canvas, the doors to creativity were thrown wide open. With successive and quick evolution in the art styles, the cubism movement employs whimsicality and leaves the painter unfettered by anything except the limitations of his own inventive ingenuity to this day.



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